Kellogg Global Hub
Northwestern University
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Sean McQuade

Positions

Northwestern University (May 2025–present)
Empirical Research Fellow
Management and Organizations Department,
Kellogg School of Management
Faculty co-supervisors: Maryam Kouchaki and Klaus Weber

Education

University of Massachusetts Amherst
MS, Data Analytics and Computational Social Science, 2025
BA, Economics, 2024

Research Interests

Organizations · Elites · Ideology · Computational Social Science

Publications

Cai, Erica, **Sean McQuade**, Kevin Young, and Brendan O'Connor (2026). Relation Extraction Across Entire Books to Reconstruct Community Networks: The AffilKG Datasets. *LREC*, May 2026.

Young, Kevin. *et al.* (2026). Gender and Age Divisions Among the Economic Power Elite: A Comparative Analysis of 16 Countries from the World Elite Database (WED). In *The Oxford Handbook of the Sociology of Global Elites*, edited by Maria Luisa Mendez, Mike Savage, and Annette Lareau, April 2026.

Bühlmann, Felix. *et al.* (2025). Varieties of Economic Elites? Preliminary Results from the World Elite Database (WED). *British Journal of Sociology*, 76: 663–673.

In Progress

Young, Kevin, **Sean McQuade**, Izaura Solipa, François Schoenberger, Jorge Quesada-Velazco, Shay O'Brien, and Anya Lu. The Ideology of the US Economic Elite.

Young, Kevin, François Schoenberger, Izaura Solipa, **Sean McQuade**, Jorge Quesada-Velazco, Shay O'Brien, and Anya Lu. Describing the US Economic Elite: Education, Demographics and Social Class.

Charlesworth, Tessa, Maryam Kouchaki, Mohsen Mosleh, and **Sean McQuade**. Prevalence, Sentiment, and Topics in Company Twitter Posts about Societal Grand Challenges.

Koh, Jodie, Seoul Lee, **Sean McQuade**, and Klaus Weber. Comparing Meaning Systems of Sustainability in Corporate and Canonical Texts.

McQuade, Sean. The Privilege of Lineage: Executive Family Ties and Navigating the U.S. Corporate Ladder.

McQuade, Sean. Ideology and Homophily in US Non-Profit Organizations.

Fan, Xinguo, Chao Ling, Peng Lu, **Sean McQuade**, Shay O'Brien, Jorge Quesada-Velazco, François Schoenberger, Izaura Solipa, and Kevin Young. A Comparative Analysis of the Philanthropic Donations of the Super-Rich in China and in the United States.

Young, Kevin, **Sean McQuade**, Izaura Solipa, and Jorge Quesada-Velazco. Is Finance Still Central? A Longitudinal Analysis of the Position of Banks and Other Financial Institutions vis-à-vis Interest Groups, Policy Planning Organizations and the Transnational Capital Class.

Awards

Center for Research on Families Research Award, 2023
University of Massachusetts, Amherst

Economics Undergraduate Research Assistantship, 2021
University of Massachusetts, Amherst

Conference Presentations

McQuade, Sean. "The Privilege of Lineage: The Role of Kinship Ties in Navigating the US Corporate Ladder." Presentation to the annual conference of the *Society for the Advancement of Socio-Economics (SASE)*, Bordeaux, France, 2 July 2026.

McQuade, Sean, and Kevin Young (joint presentation). "The US Power Elite: Evidence from the US World Elite Database (WED) Study." Presentation to the annual conference of the *Society for the Advancement of Socio-Economics (SASE)*, Limerick, Ireland, 28 June 2024.

McQuade, Sean, and Kevin Young (joint presentation). "Introducing the American Ruling Class: Evidence from the US World Elite Database (WED) Study." Presentation to the *British Journal of Sociology* inaugural conference, London School of Economics, London, 15 April 2024.

Other Experience

Cornerstone Research, Chicago, IL (2024–2025)
Analyst

Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis, St. Louis, MO (2023)
Research Intern

University of Massachusetts, Amherst, MA (2021–2024)
Research Assistant in Economics and Sociology